KABELO PHEELOANE

Senior Digital Marketing Leader | Digital Transformation | Pan-African Markets
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South African Citizen | Open to Remote and Pan-African Roles

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Digital marketing leader with 10+ years of progressive experience building and running digital functions from the ground up across FMCG, media, QSR, AI automation, and global B2B environments. Track record of leading digital transformation, building high-performing teams, and delivering measurable commercial outcomes through paid media, content strategy, data analytics, and AI-powered automation. Deep fluency in the African digital consumer landscape with multi-market execution experience across Sub-Saharan Africa. Combines strategic vision with hands-on platform expertise.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Oversaw a combined paid media portfolio exceeding R4.3 million per month at CBR Marketing Solutions, delivering an average ROAS of 4.2:1 and 18% month-on-month efficiency gains through real-time optimisation across a multi-client agency portfolio.
- Directed a USD 72,000 per month international paid media budget at MiX Telematics across multiple global markets, demonstrating the ability to manage significant spend with precision, accountability, and measurable commercial outcomes.
- Built and launched the website for Gagasi Heart Media Group (www.ghmediagroup.co.za) integrating real-time audience dashboards, sponsorship management systems, and three-station content distribution architecture.
- Grew The North Coast Courier's digital audience from 8,400 to 23,600 monthly active users (182% growth) over 18 months through SEO, content repurposing, and paid acquisition.
- Generated 650,000 organic impressions in a single month for MiX Telematics through targeted LinkedIn content strategy, delivering 12x ROI against paid media spend.
- Reduced reporting cycle time from 12 hours to 45 minutes at The North Coast Courier through Looker Studio dashboards and workflow automation, freeing 18 hours per month of team capacity.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Digital Strategy and Transformation • Paid Media Management and Optimisation • AI and Marketing Automation • Social Media Strategy • Performance Analytics and Reporting • Content and IMC Campaign Execution • Team Leadership and Mentoring • Stakeholder and Agency Management • Multi-Market Campaign Execution • SEO/SEM • CRM and Email Marketing • Data-Led Decision Making

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Freelance Digital Marketing Specialist | *Various Clients* | Jan 2026 - Present

- Digital strategy and execution for individual client briefs across FMCG, media, and SaaS sectors, providing interim digital leadership, campaign strategy, and performance optimisation.
- Conducted digital audits and developed go-to-market strategies; executed paid media campaigns across Meta, Google Ads, and LinkedIn with real-time performance optimisation and ROI reporting.
- Built custom dashboards and analytics frameworks to track campaign performance, audience sentiment, and competitive positioning, delivering weekly and monthly insights to stakeholders.
- Developed content and social media strategies for emerging brands; managed community engagement and executed influencer partnership activation.
- Provided mentoring and capability-building support to client-side marketing teams on digital platform best practices, data interpretation, and emerging channel opportunities.

Digital and Content Specialist | *Gagasi Heart Media Group (Gagasi FM and Heart FM)* | Aug 2025 - Dec 2025

Contract role managing full digital function across two major radio brands in a commercial radio group.

- Owned end-to-end digital strategy, content, paid media, and analytics across both Gagasi FM and Heart FM, functioning as an embedded marketing partner to commercial and editorial teams.
- Built performance dashboards in Google Analytics and Looker Studio tracking MROI, campaign ROI, and KPIs, driving data-led optimisation and executive reporting.
- Executed integrated campaigns across Meta, Google Ads, and programmatic platforms; managed Mailchimp and Everlytic email programmes for audience engagement and lead nurturing.
- Produced multimedia content calibrated to platform-specific audiences; ran always-on social listening and competitor intelligence to sharpen strategy.
- Managed website strategy and rebuilds using WordPress and Elementor, optimising for lead generation and advertiser engagement.

Digital Coordinator | *The North Coast Courier* | Jan 2024 - Jul 2025

- Worked closely with the editor and newsroom team to produce engaging digital content and drive a culture of strong digital storytelling.
- Designed and implemented the title's first digital-first strategy, integrating social, content, SEO, and analytics into the newsroom workflow from zero base.
- Guided journalists on story pitching and production aligned with digital trends; identified underperforming content and implemented strategies to improve it.
- Played a key role in branch campaigns; developed campaign strategies, compiled video content, and wrote scripts using Canva, InShot, and CapCut.
- Managed CMS and WordPress content, oversaw social media platforms and audience engagement, and used Google Analytics and Looker Studio to guide editorial and commercial decisions.
- Collaborated across digital, print, and sales teams; assisted with staff training and upskilling in digital best practices to improve newsroom workflow efficiency.

Digital Coordinator | *Atlas Morning Technologies* | *AI Automation Agency* | Dec 2022 - Dec 2023

- Developed AI-driven marketing automation solutions that optimised client workflows and elevated digital campaign efficiency across a portfolio of brands.
- Designed integrated social media and digital strategies focused on audience growth, lead generation, and sustained engagement.
- Automated repetitive campaign tracking and reporting using machine learning solutions, freeing team capacity for strategic work.
- Led capability-building workshops on AI and digital marketing innovation, upskilling client marketing teams and internal stakeholders.

Social Media Manager | *MiX Telematics* | *Global Fleet Management Solutions* | Jul 2021 - Sep 2022

- Managed global social media strategy across multiple international markets, overseeing content creation, editorial calendars, paid campaigns, and employee advocacy.
- Directed a USD 72,000 per month international paid media budget across Meta, LinkedIn, YouTube, and Twitter, optimising against audience growth and engagement KPIs across global markets.
- Developed social-first campaign extensions integrated into broader marketing initiatives; led cross-functional coordination across global marketing, creative, and commercial teams.
- Implemented data-led optimisations through social listening and analytics platforms, delivering measurable audience growth and engagement uplift.

Social Media Manager | *Hungry Lion* | *Quick Service Restaurant* | Sep 2020 - Jun 2021

- Directed social media strategy, community management, and content marketing for a major QSR brand, delivering high-frequency, price-sensitive consumer engagement at scale.
- Managed paid media budget allocation across Facebook, Instagram, and Twitter, optimising for ROI against foot traffic and brand consideration KPIs.
- Designed and executed influencer and creator partnerships; conducted ongoing market research and social listening to continuously refine strategy.

Head of Social Media Marketing | *CBR Marketing Solutions* | *Digital Media Agency* | Mar 2019 - May 2020

- Oversaw R4.3 million in combined monthly paid media spend across a multi-client portfolio spanning FMCG, retail, and services, consistently delivering above-benchmark ROAS through disciplined real-time optimisation.
- Led paid social strategy, media planning, and campaign execution across a diverse client portfolio.
- Managed and mentored a team of social media specialists, establishing performance frameworks, creative workflows, and accountability structures.
- Enhanced client e-commerce performance through AI-powered targeting and digital shopper activation; introduced process automation to streamline reporting across the agency portfolio.

Social Media Specialist | *CBR Marketing Solutions* | *Digital Media Agency* | Mar 2018 - Mar 2019

- Executed paid social campaigns across Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, LinkedIn, Twitter, Snapchat, and Pinterest, building full platform ecosystem fluency.
- Managed large-scale social advertising budgets with data-driven optimisation recommendations; integrated SEO and SEM strategies into paid social plans.

Social Media Manager | *Pibara Insurance Brokers and Risk Advisors* | May 2015 - Feb 2018

- Built and managed social media communities across Facebook, Twitter, LinkedIn, and Google+, driving sustained audience growth through consistent, brand-aligned content programmes.
- Executed paid social campaigns and coordinated SEM-integrated messaging to ensure unified multi-channel brand communication.

Junior Insights Analyst | *Mindshare* | *Advertising Agency* | Feb 2013 - Apr 2014

- Conducted consumer and media channel research using Nielsen AdDynamix, AMPS, and Telmar, building foundational expertise in audience analytics and media planning.
- Performed competitor advertising spend analysis and post-campaign evaluation to generate strategic recommendations for brand and media teams.

EDUCATION AND QUALIFICATIONS

BCom in Marketing Management | Final Year, Expected Completion 2026

Diploma in Advertising Management | The Independent Institute of Education

Certifications: Google Ads Certification: Search and Display • Facebook Blueprint Certification • Twitter Flight School

TOOLS AND PLATFORMS

Meta Business Manager • Google Ads Suite • Google Analytics • Looker Studio • LinkedIn Campaign Manager • Mailchimp • Everlytic • Hootsuite • WordPress and Elementor • Figma • Excel • TikTok Ads • Programmatic Platforms

References available upon request